

Alaina Portoghese

Minneapolis, MN | porto023@umn.edu | www.linkedin.com/in/alaina-portoghese

Education

University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, MN

Master of Geographic Information Science (Beginning Fall 2025)

Expected Graduation 2027

University of Denver, Denver, CO

Bachelor of Science in Environmental Science

June 2022

Minors in Geographic Information Science, Geography, Music

Professional Experience

Riley Purgatory Bluff Creek Watershed District, Chanhassen, MN

GIS Communications Specialist

Sept 2023 - Present

- Developed web maps to communicate district data and information to the public in an easily understandable format.
- Created maps for grant application and presentation purposes to effectively communicate information.
- Designed informational and marketing graphics using Adobe software to convey information and improve district visibility.
- Led events and educational activities to improve public knowledge of water resources.
- Presented district projects and findings in conference and event settings.

MN Greencorps Member

Sept 2022 - Aug 2023

- Collected soil data using an infiltrometer and the *Munsell Soil Color Book*, collected water data using a water quality sonde.
- Developed a Microsoft Access database for soil data storage.
- Created soil health lesson plans for students K-8 and other education materials for the general public.
- Designed promotional materials using Adobe software to improve district visibility.

University of Denver Department of Spanish Language, Literary and Cultural Studies, Denver, CO

Digital Audio Editor

Apr 2022 - Sept 2022

- Refined audio and removed background noise from interview audio recordings using Adobe Audition.
- Embedded sections of interview recordings into an ArcGIS StoryMap for clean presentation of interviews.

Denver Parks and Recreation, Denver, CO

City Parks Worker

June 2021 - Sept 2021

- Planted and maintained gardens, grounds, and park amenities.
- Provided answers to park users' questions about park information.

University of Denver Soil Laboratory, Denver, CO

Laboratory Assistant

Sept 2020 - June 2021

- Operated Laser Diffraction Particle Size Analyzer to determine soil particle size.
- Conducted titrations and compared soil color to the *Munsell Soil Color Book* to determine soil makeup.
- Recorded data into spreadsheets and analyzed soil data by creating graphs examining soil makeup and particle size.
- Trained other research assistants on lab procedures and data collection.

Catherine Lay Studio, Saint Paul, MN

Assistant Art Teacher

July 2017 - Aug 2020

- Taught students technical skills of painting and other artistic media.
- Created sample artwork to aid in student comprehension of instructions.
- Aided in setup and cleanup around the classroom.

Other Experience

University of Denver Department of Geography and the Environment, Denver, CO

Field Research Program Participant

Sept 2021 - Nov 2021

- Cored numerous tree species, analyzed tree rings from both ecological and climatological standpoints.
- Cored wetland peat, examined sediment layers and their paleoclimatic implications.

Skills

- **Geographic Information Systems:** ArcGIS Pro, ArcGIS Online, ArcGIS StoryMaps, ArcGIS Dashboards, ArcGIS Experience Builder
- **Other Software:** Adobe Audition, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe InDesign, Adobe Photoshop, Google Workspace, Microsoft Access, Microsoft Office Suite
- **Programming:** Arcade, Python